

Gender Discrimination in India

A Field Study through Survey and Interviews

Grade 11 Term 4 Project

Focus: School Life, Sports Environment, and Equal Opportunities

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1. Introduction

Gender discrimination means unfair treatment of a person because of their gender. In India, this can appear in families, schools, sports, workplaces, and public spaces. In the context of school and sports, discrimination may not always be direct. It can appear through lesser encouragement, fewer facilities, safety concerns, family restrictions, or stereotypes that girls should focus more on traditional norms such as household chores.

Women's rights in India are protected by the Constitution, which supports equality before the law and prohibits discrimination on the basis of sex. Even with legal protection, social attitudes can continue to shape everyday behaviour. This project studies how gender discrimination is experienced and understood by people in school and sports settings.

The project is based on a questionnaire survey, interview questions, and a response chart provided for this field study.

2. Objectives and Methodology

Objectives:

- To understand the meaning and effects of gender discrimination in India.
- To examine whether boys and girls receive equal treatment in school and sports.
- To identify barriers faced by girls in sports, such as family restrictions, lack of facilities, and safety concerns.
- To analyse patterns from survey responses and connect them with Indian reality.
- To suggest practical solutions for schools, parents, and coaches.

Methodology:

- Questionnaire survey using 10 questions.
- Data presentation through graphs and a statistical table.
- Two interviews planned: With 2 female students
- Analysis of patterns, reasons, comparisons, and practical solutions.

3. Questionnaire

1) What is your gender?

2) What is your age group?

3) Do you think boys and girls are treated equally in school?

4) Are sports facilities available to both boys and girls in your school?

5) Do you believe boys receive more encouragement in sports than girls?

6) Have you ever witnessed a girl being discouraged from playing sports due to her gender?

7) Do you think/believe parents are more supportive of boys in sports?

8) Does society expect girls to focus more on housework than sports?

9) Do you think gender discrimination in sports is decreasing in India?

10) What do you think is the biggest barrier for girls in sports?

4. Interview Section

Interviewee 1: Soumya - female student/athlete

Q1. Have you ever felt treated differently in sports or school because of your gender?

Q2. Do you feel you get the same encouragement and opportunities as your male peers in sports?

Q3. Have your family or relatives ever discouraged you from playing a sport? What reasons did they give?

Q4. Do you feel pressure to choose between sports and academics because you are a girl?

Q5. What one change would make the biggest difference for girls in sports at your school?

Summary of Soumya Interview

Soumya shared that girls sometimes experience unequal treatment and less encouragement in sports compared to boys. She mentioned that societal attitudes and family concerns can create barriers for girls who want to pursue sports seriously. According to her, balancing academics and sports is often harder for girls because of expectations placed on them. She believes awareness, equal support from schools, and positive encouragement from parents can help reduce gender discrimination.

Interviewee 2: Raagini - adult / parent / coach / teacher perspective

Q1. Growing up, did you personally face any gender-based barriers in sports or education?

Q2. In your experience, do boys and girls receive equal opportunities and resources in school sports?

Q3. Do you think social and family expectations in India hold girls back from pursuing sports seriously?

Q4. Have you ever witnessed a girl being discouraged from sport by family, peers, or the system?

Q5. What practical steps can schools and parents take to reduce gender discrimination in sports?

Summary of Raagini Interview

Raagini explained that gender discrimination in sports and education still exists in India, though conditions are slowly improving. She believes boys and girls are not always given equal opportunities or encouragement in school sports. She highlighted how family expectations, social stereotypes, and lack of support often discourage girls from participating seriously in sports. She also emphasized that schools and parents should actively encourage girls and provide equal facilities and opportunities.

5. Data Presentation

The following table and graphs are based on the provided survey response chart. The available sample size is 7 respondents for the main analytical questions.

Question	Yes	No	Sometimes	Not sure	Other / Barrier	Main statistic
Treated equally in school?	2	1	3	0		28.6%
Sports facilities for both?	5	1	1	0		71.4%
Boys get more encouragement?	5	2	0	0		71.4%
Witnessed girl discouraged?	4	3	0	0		57.1%
Parents more supportive of boys?	4	0	0	3		57.1%
Society expects girls on housework?	5	2	0	0		71.4%
Discrimination decreasing?	4	2	0	1		57.1%
Biggest barrier for girls?	0	0	0	0	Family Restrictions: 4, Lack of Facilities: 2, Safety Concerns: 1	4/7 = 57.1%

Figure 1: Stacked bar chart of survey responses.

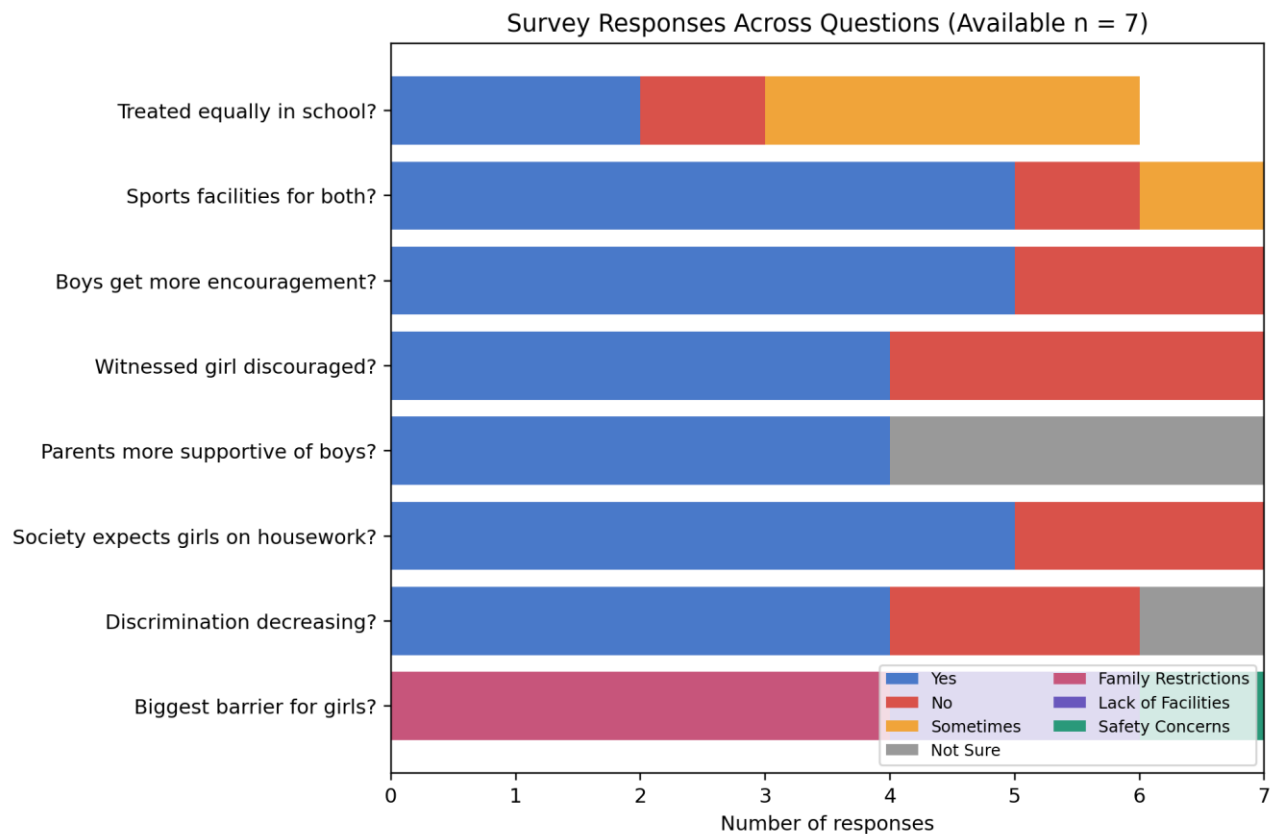
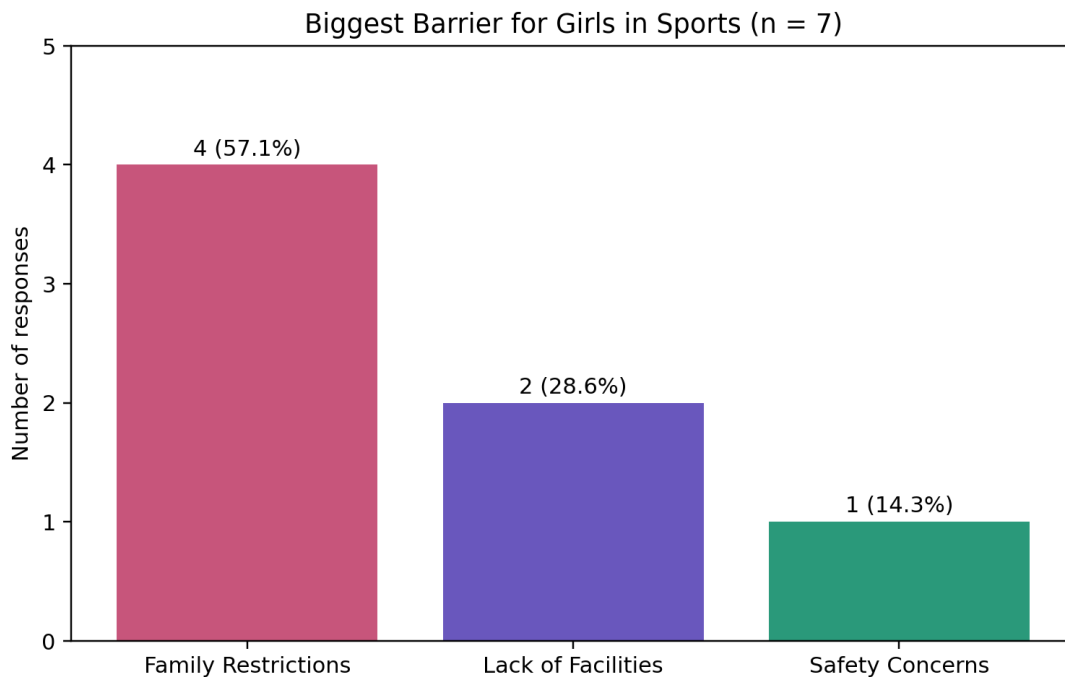


Figure 2: Additional bar chart showing the biggest barrier for girls in sports.



6. Key Findings

- Only 2 out of 6 responses for the equality-in-school question selected “Yes”, while 3 selected “Sometimes”. This suggests that equal treatment is inconsistent rather than fully achieved.
- 5 out of 7 respondents (71.4%) said sports facilities are available to both boys and girls, but this does not automatically mean equal encouragement or equal usage.
- 5 out of 7 respondents (71.4%) believed boys receive more encouragement in sports than girls.
- 4 out of 7 respondents (57.1%) had witnessed a girl being discouraged from playing sports due to gender.
- 5 out of 7 respondents (71.4%) felt society expects girls to focus more on housework than sports.
- The biggest barrier identified was family restrictions, chosen by 4 out of 7 respondents (57.1%), followed by lack of facilities (28.6%) and safety concerns (14.3%).

7. Analysis and Interpretation

The data shows that gender discrimination in sports is not only about physical facilities. A majority of respondents said facilities are available to both boys and girls, but an equal or larger majority also believed boys receive more encouragement. This means the main problem may be social behaviour and mindset rather than only infrastructure.

A strong pattern appears around encouragement and family expectations. When 71.4% of respondents believe boys get more encouragement, it suggests that boys may be seen as more naturally connected to sports. Girls may have to prove themselves more or may be pushed toward activities considered safer or more academically useful.

The finding that 57.1% of respondents had witnessed a girl being discouraged from sports is important because it shows discrimination is not only an abstract issue. It appears in daily life through comments, restrictions, teasing, or lack of support.

The biggest barrier was family restrictions. This can exist because of safety concerns, fear of injury, concern about studies, traditional beliefs, or the idea that girls should spend more time at home. Lack of facilities and safety concerns were also selected, showing that schools and communities need both social change and better practical support.

8. Link with Indian Reality

- In many parts of India, boys are encouraged to play outdoors from a young age, while girls may face restrictions on time, clothing, travel, and safety.
- Gender stereotypes such as “sports are for boys” can reduce girls’ confidence and participation.
- Girls may be asked to focus more on academics or household responsibilities, especially as they grow older.
- Even when school facilities exist, girls may not get equal practice time, coaching attention, team selection confidence, or family permission to compete outside school.
- Successful Indian sportswomen show that girls can excel when they receive training, family support, safety, and equal opportunities.

9. Comparison Within Responses

Male vs female responses:

The uploaded chart does not separate answers by gender, so a direct statistical comparison between male and female respondents cannot be made from the available data. However, the questionnaire includes gender as Question 1, so the final survey sheet should compare whether girls report more unequal treatment than boys.

10. Suggestions

1. Schools should provide equal practice time, equipment, coaching attention, and team selection opportunities for boys and girls.
2. Parents and coaches should actively encourage girls to continue sports and should not treat sports as less important for girls.
3. Schools should conduct awareness programs on gender equality, stereotypes, and respect in sports.
4. Safe transport, proper supervision, and secure changing areas should be provided so that safety concerns do not become a reason to stop girls from participating.
5. Female athletes should be highlighted in assemblies, boards, and school events to create role models for younger girls.

11. Conclusion

This field study shows that gender discrimination in school and sports continues to exist in both visible and invisible forms. The survey data suggests that boys are still perceived to receive more encouragement in sports, while girls face discouragement, social expectations, and family restrictions. Although many respondents believe facilities exist for both boys and girls, equal facilities do not guarantee equal opportunity. Real equality requires encouragement, safety, confidence, family support, and equal treatment by schools and coaches.

The most important conclusion is that gender discrimination can be reduced through practical school-level action and social awareness. When girls receive equal facilities, support, and respect, they can participate and perform with the same seriousness as boys.